

Mana Motuhake

Executive Summary

There is a new generation of Tangata Whenua and Tangata Tiriti who recognise that being forced to work within colonial systems does not advance mana motuhake. Those systems were never designed to uphold Māori authority, Māori wellbeing, or Māori futures.

The only way this nation can truly function is when Māori assert tino rangatiratanga across all domains. Constitutional transformation is required to rebalance power in Aotearoa, restore Māori authority, and honour the relationship envisaged by our tūpuna in 1840.

Te Tiriti o Waitangi cannot be settled. It is a living constitutional covenant, where te tino rangatiratanga of Tangata Whenua is inalienable.

Te Pāti Māori does not speak of Land Back as symbolism; we will implement it.

Context

Since 1840, the retention and return of land has been the central political aspiration of Tangata Whenua, and the unifying struggle of the tino rangatiratanga movement.

From Dame Whina Cooper's 1975 land march to noho whenua across Takaparawhā, Whāingaroa, Pākaitore, Ngāwha, Te Kuri a Pāoa, and the four-year occupation of Ihumātao, Māori resistance has been constant, principled, and enduring.

The establishment of the Waitangi Tribunal acknowledged breach but did not restore power. Settlement processes have too often been framed as closure rather than continuity, and reconciliation rather than justice.

As Moana Jackson reminded us: treaties are not settled, they are honoured.

The Westminster system continues to constrain Māori authority through colonial tools of control. Mana motuhake cannot be achieved by reform alone. It requires transformation through the restoration of power and resources to Tangata Whenua and the establishment of Māori-governed systems.

Our Position

Te Tiriti o Waitangi is the foundation of a living constitutional relationship between Tangata Whenua and the Crown. Both parties carry ongoing obligations which have no expiry date.

Mana motuhake requires:

- Parallel governance.
- Māori authority over Māori affairs.
- The restoration of land, law, and decision-making power.

By working alongside Tangata Tiriti and Tangata Moana, we can decolonise and re-indigenise Aotearoa, and realise an Aotearoa Hou grounded in Te Tiriti.

Te Pāti Māori will...

Stage 1

1.Implement all Matike Mai Aotearoa recommendations immediately.

2. Entrench the Māori electorates.

3. Return the foreshore and seabed to mana whenua.

4. Establish a Parliamentary Commissioner for Te Tiriti o Waitangi.

5. End all foreign freehold land sales, replacing them with leasehold only.

6. End perpetual leases.

Stage 2

7. Abolish "full and final" and "large natural groupings" settlement policies.

8. Introduce a first right of refusal for mana whenua on all private land.

9. Insert retrospective relativity clauses into all Te Tiriti settlements.

10. Make Waitangi Tribunal recommendations binding.

11. Return all conservation land to mana whenua.

Stage 3

12. Require Māori wards and mana whenua representation in all councils.

13. Return all central and local government land to mana whenua.

14. Remove the British Royal Family as Head of State.

15. Recognise Aotearoa as the country's official name.

16. Establish a Māori Parliament.

1. Implementing Constitutional Transformation

Te Pāti Māori commits to implementing all Mātike Mai Aotearoa recommendations, grounded in tikanga, He Whakaputanga, Te Tiriti, and international Indigenous rights.

2. Māori Parliament

A Māori Parliament will hold authority over Māori programmes, funding streams, and governance structures accountable to Māori alone.

3. Land Back

Te Pāti Māori will return:

- Foreshore and seabed
- Crown and council land
- Conservation land

Private land sales will first be offered to mana whenua & perpetual leases will end.

4. Overhauling the Te Tiriti Settlement Process

The settlement framework will be reformed to ensure durability, justice, and hapū-level authority.

5. Ensuring Effective Crown Oversight

Māori representation will be entrenched, and a Parliamentary Commissioner for Te Tiriti will oversee Crown compliance.

6. Te Tiriti Impact Statements

All legislation, regulations, and Cabinet papers will be required to include Te Tiriti impact statements and compliance analysis.

Our Commitment

Mana motuhake is not a moment. It is an inheritance and a responsibility to our mokopuna.

The role of Te Pāti Māori is to unlock every available resource across government for Te Iwi Māori using every tool, lever and pathway available.

Te Pāti Māori will continue to defend and make space for rangatiratanga across all domains and at every opportunity, until Māori authority is restored, upheld, and protected.